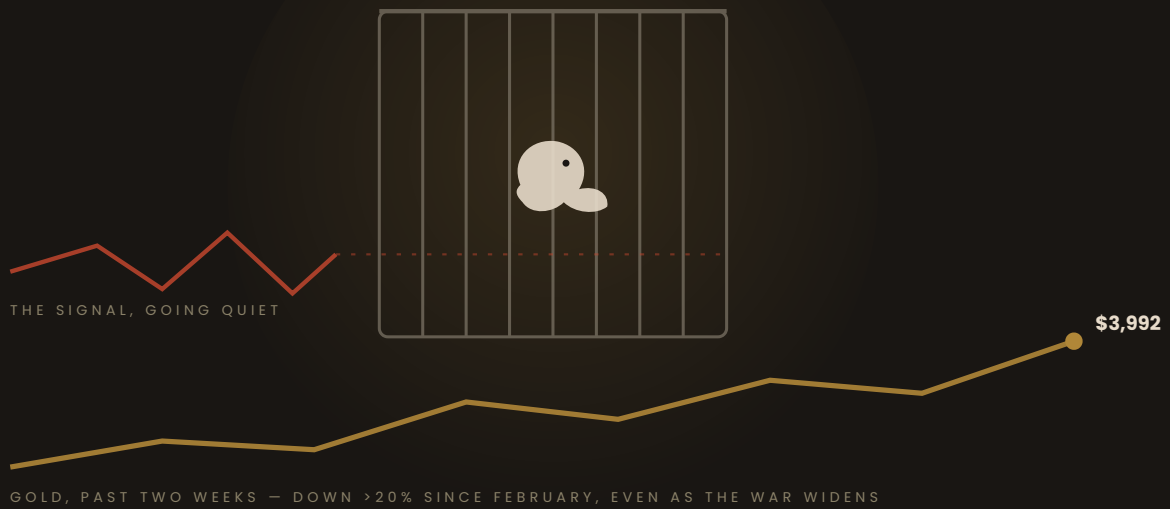


THE CURRENT BRIEFING OF

MERIDIAN

Twelve desks. One world.

FRIDAY · 17 JULY 2026



THE WORLD

Washington weighs seizing Iran's main oil terminal outright, as a sixth night of strikes makes this the war's bloodiest week yet

PROPERTY

A month after zero launches, developers bid \$2.128 billion for a single GLS site — the first non-CBD parcel ever to cross that line

CURIOSITIES

Two of the coldest "stars" in the Dyson-sphere hunt turn out to be background galaxies, not megastructures

INSIDE THIS EDITION

TWELVE DESKS · ONE WORLD

The signals that stopped confirming the story

A week where gold quietly stopped acting like a war hedge, a compliance rule finally named a real company, and a parliament's pending vote — held open, not guessed at, in our last issue — resolved exactly as scheduled.

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FROM THE DESK

"Not everything that counts can be counted, and not everything that can be counted counts."

— William Bruce Cameron, *Informal Sociology: A Casual Introduction to Sociological Thinking* (1963)

The line is almost always attributed to Einstein instead — a misattribution so durable that physicists' own institutes have had to publish corrections. It is, this issue keeps noticing, a perfect specimen of its own argument: a signal (the authorship) that everyone still reads wrong, decades after the correction was available to anyone who looked. Cameron's actual point was narrower and more useful than the quote's internet afterlife suggests — that a good measurement and a true one are not always the same thing, which is this week's theme in miniature.

THE STRIP — AS OF THURSDAY 16 JUL NY/SG CLOSE (ASIA FRIDAY-OPEN PENDING)

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	NOTE
S&P 500	7,533.77	-0.51% Thu
STI	~5,521	-0.69% Thu
US 10Y	~4.55%	eased, 2nd session
DXY	~100.54	soft
Brent	~\$84.9	+ one-month high
Gold	~\$3,992	-2.0% Thu
BTC	~\$64.1k	flat/soft

USD/SGD carried at its last confirmed print (~1.29) — Friday's Asia-open cross was unconfirmed at Singapore press time and is held rather than guessed. Market data is explanation, not advice — see Macro, p15.

SOURCES · William Bruce Cameron, *Informal Sociology* (Random House, 1963), p.13 — the original source of the "not everything that counts" line, per university-library and physics-society misattribution corrections. Market levels: CNBC, TheStreet, Yahoo Finance, Trading Economics, Fortune, XTB/CryptoBriefing (15-16 Jul 2026).

THE WORLD · GULF CRISIS

Washington weighs seizing Kharg Island itself, as a sixth night of strikes makes this the war's deadliest week

The 20% Hormuz toll (No. 43-44) is old news now. What has actually widened is the target list — and, reportedly, the ambition.

US and Iranian forces traded strikes for a sixth consecutive night Thursday, as CENTCOM hit Iranian command centres, air-defence sites, missile and drone facilities and coastal surveillance posts it said were needed "to further degrade Iran's ability to threaten innocent mariners" in the strait. Iran's health ministry now puts the cumulative toll since strikes resumed last Wednesday at least 35 killed and more than 300 wounded — a figure that supersedes the single-strike count this desk carried in No. 44, and the highest running total of the conflict.¹

A US aircraft separately fired on and disabled the tanker *Belma* — unladen, US-sanctioned — deep in the Gulf as it sailed toward Iran's Kharg Island terminal in defiance of the reinstated blockade, a strike Bloomberg reads as evidence Washington is "widening the scope" of naval operations rather than merely enforcing them passively. More significant still: Trump is reportedly leaning toward broadening US military operations further, and has discussed the possibility of seizing Kharg Island itself — Iran's primary oil-export terminal — a materially larger step than any strike wave to date, though nothing has been confirmed as ordered.²

A second, smaller strike hit a Bandar Abbas neighbourhood Thursday, killing one and wounding eight per the regional health ministry; Iranian state media reported a second consecutive night of strikes near Ahvaz. Iran retaliated with missile and drone fire on US assets in Kuwait, Bahrain and Jordan — sirens sounded in both Gulf capitals — widening its own target list beyond the five states it struck the week before. Hormuz shipping traffic, already thin, continues to dwindle.³

WASHINGTON —

**BLOOMBERG/CNBC
FRAMING**

Reports the *Belma* strike and the Kharg Island discussion as a widening of operational scope, distinct from the settled, permanent withdrawal of the 20% toll — two separate tracks, one military and escalating, one diplomatic and closed.

BEIJING

— MFA FRAMING

Spokesman Lin Jian said China is "deeply concerned over resumed military conflict," urging all sides to "remain calm, exercise restraint... avoid return of war" — a notably narrow ask, consistent with Beijing's posture throughout, given roughly 40% of China's oil imports transit Hormuz.

AL

— GULF/REGIONAL

JAZEERA FRAMING

Leads on the casualty count and the widening target list, with an analysis piece noting Iran's own objectives "seem to have grown" toward something resembling Gulf hegemony — while reporting Gulf states are privately pressing Washington to continue until Iran's leadership changes.

35+

KILLED SINCE STRIKES RESUMED LAST WEDNESDAY, PER IRAN'S HEALTH MINISTRY — THE CONFLICT'S HIGHEST CUMULATIVE TOLL TO DATE

SOURCES · 1 Al Jazeera live blog, 16 Jul 2026; CNN live updates, 15-16 Jul 2026. 2 Bloomberg, "US widens naval operations in the Gulf," 16 Jul 2026; CNBC, 14 Jul 2026 (Kharg Island). 3 Al Jazeera/AFP, citing Hormozgan University of Medical Sciences, 16 Jul 2026; IRNA via Al Jazeera, 16 Jul 2026. China: Bloomberg/Express Tribune, 14 Jul 2026. Gulf reaction: Euronews, Al Jazeera, 12-16 Jul 2026.

THE WORLD · A QUESTION, RESOLVED

Kyiv's parliament confirms Koretskyi 289–226; the vote No. 44 held open a day ago is now a fact, not a forecast

Congo's Ebola toll climbs past 750, and the World Cup final is two days away with nothing left to guess at.

Ukraine's parliament confirmed Serhiy Koretskyi, the former Naftogaz chief executive, as prime minister Thursday by a vote of 289 to 226 — the exact question this magazine declined to guess at in No. 44, published a day before the vote actually happened. President Zelensky's nomination followed Yuliia Svyrydenko's dismissal 258-1 earlier in the week; Koretskyi has framed winter energy-grid resilience as his immediate priority, drawing on his experience running Ukraine's state gas company through repeated strikes on its production facilities. One notable gap in the reshuffle: the defence minister post remains vacant.¹

In the Democratic Republic of Congo, the Bundibugyo-virus Ebola outbreak has climbed to 2,011 confirmed cases and 754 deaths as of the latest situational report, with Ituri province worst-hit at 1,808 cases and 631 deaths — now the third-largest Ebola outbreak on record, and spreading faster than prior outbreaks per WHO-adjacent reporting. A US citizen aid worker tested positive and was medically evacuated to Germany on 13 July, the first international medevac of this outbreak. WHO has not yet declared the outbreak a Public Health Emergency of International Concern, a threshold this desk will flag clearly if crossed rather than pre-empt.²

Koretskyi inherits a cabinet still missing a defence minister, a detail worth sitting with rather than skipping past: Ukraine is entering its fifth wartime winter-preparation cycle with an energy-focused prime minister confirmed and a security portfolio still open. Zelensky's office has not announced a timeline for filling it, and this desk holds that as an open question rather than reading intent into the silence either way.

This is the rare case where holding a question open for one issue cost nothing: the vote happened exactly when scheduled, exactly as reported as pending a day earlier. Not every open question in this issue resolves so cleanly or so fast — see Property, p6, and The Good Life, p11, for two that are still genuinely unresolved, and The Long Read, p21, for why that distinction is the whole point.³

THE CHATTER — A VACANCY NOBODY'S EXPLAINING YET

Kyiv-watchers on English-language Ukrainian outlets flagged the unfilled defence-ministry seat as the reshuffle's genuinely open question — read either as a deliberate pause for a heavyweight appointment, or as friction inside the coalition that simply hasn't surfaced yet. This desk holds it as unresolved rather than guessing which.

IN BRIEF

The World Cup final kicks off Sunday at MetLife Stadium, Argentina v Spain — Messi against Barcelona teenager Lamine Yamal, a fixture already confirmed and not requiring a forecast. England play France in Saturday's third-place match.

Ukraine's winter-prep coalition. The nine-country "Anti-Ballistic Missile Coalition" backing the Freya air-defence project (No. 44) continues alongside Zelensky's separate request for 300 Patriot interceptors — no new movement to report this week.

Congo's containment lag. Roughly 80% of new Ebola cases now trace to transmission chains health officials can no longer follow, per WHO-adjacent reporting — the clearest single sign the outbreak is outrunning the response built to contain it.

289–226

RADA'S CONFIRMATION VOTE FOR PM KORETSKYI —
RESOLVING, ON SCHEDULE, THE EXACT QUESTION NO. 44
DECLINED TO GUESS AT

SOURCES · 1 Ukrainews, Kyiv Post, Pravda, 16 Jul 2026; United24 Media, 16 Jul 2026 (defence-minister vacancy). 2 WHO/ReliefWeb situational report, UN News, 10–14 Jul 2026; CDC release, 10 Jul 2026 (medevac). 3 FIFA match centre schedule, Jul 2026.

SINGAPORE · AVIATION & TRANSIT

Changi eyes six new routes ahead of Terminal 5, as the Downtown Line closes early tonight for testing

The airport's own capacity plan and a commuter's Friday night collide this week — both quietly about the same thing: what the next decade of Singapore's infrastructure looks like.

Changi Airport is preparing to add direct flights to six new destinations — Banda Aceh and Banjarmasin in Indonesia, Hai Phong and Da Lat in Vietnam, and Almaty and Tashkent in Central Asia — as it scales toward Terminal 5, which is planned to lift the airport's capacity from roughly 90 million to about 140 million passengers a year by the mid-2030s. Separately, Komatsu confirmed the first full-scale deployment of its "Smart Construction" digital-survey technology at the T5 site this month, an early operational marker on a project still years from opening.¹

Commuters feel a smaller version of the same expansion tonight: Downtown Line trains end service at 11:30pm on Friday nights through 5 September, resuming only at 8:30am on Saturdays, while LTA runs DTL3e systems-integration testing; shuttle buses S42 and S43 cover the gap between 5am and 8:30am. The parallel Thursday-East-West-Line testing window that ran from May to early July has already concluded.²

Neither story makes headlines the way a defamation verdict or a cadres conference does, but together they're a more accurate read of what actually occupies a transport planner's calendar most weeks: a capacity plan measured in decades, and a testing schedule measured in Friday nights, both grinding forward on their own separate, mostly invisible timetables.

THE CHATTER — READING THE ROUTE LIST

Aviation-forum commentary reads the Banda Aceh/Banjarmasin/Hai Phong/Da Lat cluster as classic secondary-city infill — routes that build connector traffic and load factor well before T5 needs to justify its scale with marquee long-haul additions. Almaty and Tashkent are the more interesting signal: Changi's first direct look at Central Asia, a region it has never served non-stop before.

ALSO THIS WEEK

Haze watch, still calm. Central Singapore's PM2.5 reading was 61 on 10 July — still "good" — but MSS/ASEAN forecasts put roughly 80% odds of El Niño compounding with a positive Indian Ocean Dipole through October, and Indonesia's Riau province has already declared a fire emergency after hotspot counts roughly doubled year-on-year.

Komatsu's T5 tie-in. The digital-survey deployment confirmed 8 July is an early construction-phase marker, not a completion signal — worth logging now precisely so this desk isn't caught restating "T5 is years away" as news the next time a similar contractor update lands.

90m → 140m

CHANGI'S PLANNED ANNUAL-PASSENGER CAPACITY, BEFORE AND AFTER TERMINAL 5 — THE SCALE THE NEW ROUTE LIST IS QUIETLY BUILDING TOWARD

Tuesday's Q2 GDP beat (5.7% YoY, No. 43-44) continues to frame the calmer of this week's two infrastructure stories: an airport confidently planning six new routes a decade out, and a rail network absorbing a few noisy Friday nights now so the next line opens on schedule later.

Worth a plain, practical note for a Friday-night commuter: the DTL3e testing window runs to 5 September, which means tonight's early closure is one of roughly eight such Fridays this reader will need to plan around before the line's own capacity upgrade actually lands — a small, recurring cost for an upgrade that, unlike Terminal 5, is genuinely close rather than a decade out.

SOURCES · 1 Aviation A2Z, 15 Jul 2026; The Star (ASEAN Plus), 14 Jul 2026; Komatsu Newsroom, 8 Jul 2026. 2 LTA service advisory via TheSmartLocal, Jul 2026. Haze: aqicn.org, 10 Jul 2026; Mongabay, Indonesia regional haze-risk coverage, Jul 2026.

PROPERTY · LAND SALES

Bayshore Drive draws a \$2.128 billion bid — the first non-CBD GLS site ever to cross that line

A month after developers launched nothing at all, the same industry just placed only the third bid above \$2 billion in the programme's history.

The Bayshore Drive mixed-use GLS tender closed Wednesday with a top bid of S\$2.128 billion — S\$1,323 per square foot per plot ratio — from a four-way joint venture of Frasers Property, Sunway MCL, Sekisui House and Lum Chang, beating a CDL-Hong Leong-Hong Realty-TID consortium's S\$2.10 billion bid and a CapitaLand Development-UOL bid at S\$1.986 billion. It is only the third GLS tender ever to draw a bid above S\$2 billion, and the first time a non-CBD site has done it — a land-price benchmark that will anchor future launch pricing across the wider east-coast precinct near the future Bedok South MRT station.¹

The result lands inside the rebound this desk flagged as likely after June's unprecedented zero-launch month (No. 44), and it's the land-cost side of that rebound rather than the retail side: Lentor Gardens Residences (previewed 4-5 July, No. 44) books this Saturday, and Dunearn House (full pricing published, No. 38) books 25 July — this desk is holding both booking-day results as the actual next peg, not restating pricing already on the record.²

THE WATCHLIST — TWO EN-BLOCKS, STILL STUCK

Balestier Regency's fourth collective-sale attempt (72 units, S\$255m guide) closed 9 July with no result announced; High Point's fifth attempt (S\$580m guide) closed 9 June and remains equally unresolved. Neither has a stated timeline for a result, unlike URA's own multi-week evaluation window for Bayshore Drive — a distinction this issue's Long Read (p21) returns to.

ALSO NOTED

URA's full Q2 release — transaction volumes and district-level detail beyond the 1 July flash this desk already covered (No. 39) — lands 24 July, after this issue closes; held for then rather than re-stated now.

\$2.128B

TOP BAYSHORE DRIVE BID — THE FIRST NON-CBD GLS SITE EVER TO DRAW A BID OVER \$2 BILLION

The owner-investor read here isn't the price alone — it's the sequencing. A month of zero launches followed almost immediately by developers paying a record land price for a non-CBD parcel argues against reading June as the start of a slowdown; it reads more like inventory timing, with the same appetite simply paused for a few weeks around the school holidays rather than genuinely cooled. The three-way bid spread at Bayshore Drive is itself informative: the winning JV's \$1,323 psf ppr sits only 6% above the second-place consortium's \$1,250 psf ppr, a tight enough gap to suggest genuine competitive tension rather than one outlier bidder overpaying alone.

The real test comes once Lentor Gardens' and Dunearn House's actual booking-day sales numbers land this week and next: if both clear briskly, the Bayshore bid will look like confirmation of intact demand at higher price points rather than an outlier land bet. If they don't, this desk will report that plainly too, rather than assume the bid settles the question on its own. Either way, Balestier Regency and High Point's continued silence is worth holding as a separate signal — a stalled en-bloc says something different about seller expectations than a stalled launch says about buyer demand, and this desk isn't collapsing the two into one story just because both are property news.

SOURCES · 1 EdgeProp, ERA/Stacked Homes commentary, 15-16 Jul 2026. 2 EdgeProp, "Lentor Gardens Residences preview," 4 & 6 Jul 2026 (No. 44); The Edge Singapore, "Dunearn House full pricing," 9-10 Jul 2026 (No. 38). Balestier/High Point: EdgeProp/TracyGoh en-bloc trackers, Jul 2026.

TECHNOLOGY · AI CHIPS

Nvidia's whitelist finally names a casualty, as DeepSeek V4's legacy-model grace window narrows to a week

The compliance rule this desk covered as an abstraction in No. 44 just became a specific company's problem.

Nvidia's new Asia buyer-screening system — which No. 44 reported was failing more than half of past customers evaluated — has its first named casualty. The FT reports Singapore-based firm Megaspeed has been flagged for allegedly facilitating the transfer of banned Nvidia equipment between June 2024 and June 2025; Nvidia's compliance teams have physically inspected data centres in Singapore, Malaysia and Japan, and cut buyers can reapply with ownership documents, end-user agreements and facility-layout records. A May 31 BIS guidance update added a mandatory ultimate-parent-company ownership check even for Singapore- and Japan-incorporated buyers.¹

Separately, a Commerce Department official told a hearing Tuesday that "regulatory action on chips and AI is coming," while declining to say Washington plans to reinstate the Biden-era global AI diffusion caps. Nvidia's own China market share has fallen to roughly 50% from more than 90% as Huawei ramps Ascend output toward a projected 2 million units this year; Jensen Huang has said he has "largely conceded" the Chinese market to Huawei.²

Megaspeed's case is worth watching less for its outcome than for what it tells other buyers about the whitelist's actual mechanics: compliance teams are understood to be cross-checking shipping manifests, ownership structures and order histories against known reroute patterns, not applying a simple country filter — precisely why a Singapore-incorporated firm with no stated China ties can still be caught. Nvidia has not published an appeals timeline, so this desk cannot yet say how long a wrongly-flagged buyer would need to wait for reinstatement, and isn't guessing at one.

THE CHATTER — WHAT A NAMED BUYER ACTUALLY CHANGES

Trade-compliance forums read Megaspeed's naming as the whitelist crossing from theoretical to consequential: a rule that "fails over half of past buyers" is an abstraction until one of those buyers has a name and a real business at stake. Practical read for other Singapore-based firms: expect due-diligence paperwork on ownership structure to matter now as much as end-use declarations.

IN BRIEF

DeepSeek V4's retirement deadline. The 24 July cutoff for legacy deepseek-chat/deepseek-reasoner API names (No. 44) is now one week out; after it, old calls fail and traffic auto-routes to V4-Flash during a grace window. No independent GPT-5.6-specific benchmark against V4 has surfaced yet — comparisons still circulating use GPT-5.5 figures.

RTX 5090 street pricing has drifted no further since June's climb — still \$4,300 and up, premium AIB cards above \$5,000 — a structural memory shortage, not a fresh event (see The Home Lab, facing page).

>50%

SHARE OF PAST ASIAN BUYERS NVIDIA'S WHITELIST HAS FAILED — NOW WITH A NAMED COMPANY ATTACHED TO THE NUMBER

DeepSeek's narrowing grace window is a reminder that the compute-export story and the model-capability story remain permanently entangled: a Chinese lab's flagship model graduates to official release with a 1-million-token context window the same fortnight Washington signals further chip-export tightening — whether that capability gap closes or widens over the next year remains this desk's single most consequential open question. TSMC's own Q2 earnings, due the same week, should offer the clearest read yet on how much of the whitelist-driven order uncertainty is actually showing up in foundry bookings rather than staying confined to Nvidia's own compliance paperwork.

THE HOME LAB · BUYER'S MARKET

A named compliance casualty won't move consumer GPU prices — but the shortage underneath it is a genuinely different story

The real home-lab news this fortnight is software, not silicon: a friendlier context window and a faster local toolchain matter more than any single card refresh.

Megaspeed's case (facing page) sits at the enterprise, data-centre end of the compliance net — a home-lab builder buying a single consumer card isn't the target. But the shortage a home builder actually feels is structural, not enforcement-driven: AI datacentres could consume up to 70% of world memory output this year, up from 20-30% in 2022 per IDC, and that demand is what's driving GDDR7 scarcity into consumer cards. RTX 5090 street pricing remains \$4,300 and climbing, AIB production is down 20-40% through H1, and the RTX 5070 Ti is effectively end-of-life. Nvidia's next consumer generation isn't expected this year; AMD's is pushed to late 2027 or 2028.¹

On the software side, the actual news is better: Ollama's July build adds roughly 90% faster Gemma 4 token generation on Apple Silicon via multi-token prediction, plus improved iGPU/CLIP offload and CUDA/Vulkan/MLX handling; llama.cpp has crossed 120,000 GitHub stars with continuous MIT-licensed releases. For hardware that fits a home rig without chasing Blackwell-tier pricing, Qwen 3.6 27B (77.2% SWE-bench, fits 24GB at Q4) remains the best all-rounder, with Gemma 3 27B and Phi-4 14B the easiest self-hosting picks on more modest cards.²

Two supply stories on facing pages, one shared root: an export-compliance net built for enterprise buyers and a consumer memory shortage built by enterprise demand are, underneath, the same scarcity — which is exactly why the software side of this desk keeps outrunning the hardware side lately. A builder weighing a purchase this month is better served asking what a smarter local toolchain can already do on hardware already owned, rather than whether this is finally the week a Blackwell-tier card gets affordable.

THE WORKAROUND — THE POWER BILL NOBODY BUDGETS FOR

Global data-centre power demand is forecast to rise 27% this year to 132GW, with AI-optimised servers alone projected to draw 175TWh — up 84% year-on-year, per Gartner. It's an enterprise-scale figure, but the same electricity-price pressure shows up in miniature on a home rig running inference around the clock; worth a line item next to the GPU price itself, not an afterthought.

STILL ON THE SHELF

Nvidia's RTX Spark (Computex-announced, 20-core Arm CPU plus a Blackwell GPU, up to 128GB unified memory) remains the most interesting home-lab-adjacent hardware on the horizon — no ship date confirmed yet, so this desk isn't re-listing the spec sheet until one lands.

llama.cpp's 120,000-star milestone is worth noting as a maturity signal rather than a feature: an MIT-licensed inference engine with that much sustained contributor attention is a genuinely lower-risk long-term bet for a home lab than any single hardware purchase.

~90%

FASTER GEMMA 4 TOKEN GENERATION ON APPLE SILICON VIA OLLAMA'S JULY BUILD — THE FORTNIGHT'S MOST USEFUL HOME-LAB UPGRADE, AND IT COST NOTHING

The power-cost angle (facing column) deserves the same honest treatment this desk gives every other number: a home rig running inference continuously is a genuinely small fraction of a hyperscale data centre's draw, but it is not zero, and a builder who hasn't checked their own electricity tariff against an always-on local model's actual duty cycle is quietly paying a bill nobody itemised for them.

THE KIT · WEARABLES & AR

A \$849 pair of gaming glasses ships in September, days before Samsung's own smart-glasses reveal

Two very different bets on what a face-worn screen is actually for, landing inside the same fortnight.

ASUS's ROG Xreal R1 opened preorders this week at US\$849, with shipping for new orders pushed to September. The spec sheet is squarely aimed at a PC/console gamer rather than an everyday-wear buyer: a 0.55-inch Sony Micro-OLED panel at 240Hz refresh and 0.01ms response, a 171-inch virtual screen at 57-degree field of view, Bose-tuned speakers, and either USB-C or a ROG Control Dock for DisplayPort/HDMI hookup to a PC, Xbox, PlayStation or Switch — a genuinely different use-case from the everyday-wear smart glasses this desk has tracked most of the year.¹

Samsung's Galaxy Unpacked lands 22 July in London, with Galaxy Glasses now expected alongside the Z Fold 8 and Z Flip 8. Pre-event leaks (unconfirmed, flag accordingly) point to roughly 50g weight, a 12MP camera, a 155mAh battery, directional speakers, a touch-sensitive panel, a dedicated camera button and dual privacy-indicator LEDs, at a rumoured US\$379-499 — no display in this first version, with a display-equipped model reportedly slated for 2027. It runs Android XR with Gemini, offloading compute to a paired Galaxy phone.²

THE CHATTER — TWO BETS, ONE SHELF

AR-hardware forums read the Xreal R1 and Samsung's rumoured Glasses as occupying genuinely different niches rather than competing directly: one is an immersive display for a stationary session, the other an all-day wearable meant to disappear. The interesting overlap is price — if Samsung's leaked \$379-499 range holds, both devices will sit closer together on a shelf than their use-cases suggest.

STILL ON THE SHELF

RingConn Gen 3 (No. 44's reviewed 17-day-battery ring) and Meta's \$299 no-branding "Meta Glasses" line (announced 23 Jun, Muse Spark AI from day one) remain unchanged this fortnight — no new peg to report.

The 2027 display tier. Samsung's rumoured display-equipped Galaxy Glasses follow-up is worth flagging now precisely so this desk doesn't treat it as news again when a formal roadmap eventually surfaces — a distant, unconfirmed sequel is not this fortnight's story.

240Hz

REFRESH RATE ON THE XREAL R1'S MICRO-OLED PANEL — THE SPEC THIS DESK EXPECTS PC/CONSOLE REVIEWERS TO ACTUALLY TEST FIRST

Treat Samsung's leaked pricing and specs as exactly that — pre-event leaks, not confirmed hardware — until the 22 July keynote actually happens; this desk will report the reveal, not the rumour, once it lands. The gap between a leaked spec sheet and a keynote confirmation is precisely the kind of unresolved signal this issue keeps returning to (see The Long Read, p21).

Worth a genuine comparison once both devices are actually reviewable: the Xreal R1 is unambiguous about its use-case — a stationary gaming session, tethered or docked — while Samsung's rumoured Glasses are explicitly betting on all-day wearability at a similar price point. If the leaked \$379-499 range holds, the real test for a reader choosing between them won't be spec sheets at all, but which use-case they actually have.

SOURCES · 1 Tom's Hardware, "ASUS ROG Xreal R1 AR glasses pre-orders," Jul 2026; Road to VR, Jul 2026. 2 Gagadget, "Samsung Galaxy Unpacked set for July 22," Jul 2026; Geeky Gadgets, TechRadar, Jul 2026 (leaked specs, unconfirmed).

CONNECTED HOME · MATTER & THREAD

A firmware update switches on a radio IKEA's own hub has been quietly carrying for years

Nothing new was installed. The capability was already there, waiting for a software flag to turn it on — this desk's favourite kind of upgrade.

IKEA has rolled out Dirigera hub firmware v2.805.6, activating a Matter Controller function — onboarding and managing third-party Matter devices via the IKEA Home Smart app — and switching on the Thread Border Router radio that has sat dormant in the hub's own chip since launch. Both features are beta and must be enabled manually, and require IKEA Home Smart app v1.51 (iOS) or v1.47 (Android). For a Lutron-to-Home-Assistant migrator, it's one less dedicated Thread border router to buy — hardware the reader already owns, doing a job it wasn't previously asked to do.¹

Elsewhere, the Matter/Thread ecosystem is genuinely quiet: Home Assistant 2026.7 (No. 44) remains the current stable release, with 2026.8 not due until the first Wednesday of August; Philips Hue's promised concurrent Zigbee-plus-Thread firmware still has no confirmed ship date beyond "later this year"; and Aqara's Camera Hub G350 SmartThings bridge (No. 44) is still beta, with PTZ and recording support still described only as "later this year." None of these earn a fresh mention beyond this one line — correctly held as continuity, not re-explained.²

The pattern across all three is worth naming directly: this is a season of enabling rather than shipping. IKEA's radio was already soldered in; Hue's concurrent firmware is written but not yet released; Aqara's SmartThings bridge exists in beta but not general availability. A migrator reading this desk for buying advice will find remarkably little to actually buy this fortnight — which is not the same as nothing happening. It's a reminder that a genuinely local-first ecosystem advances mostly through software decisions on hardware that's already sold, not through a steady drumbeat of new purchases.

A hardware capability that was there all along, only now switched on, is this issue's theme in a single sentence — see The Long Read, p21, for the pattern running underneath several of this week's stories. It's worth asking, the next time a hub or router update lands with a short changelog, what else the box already sitting on the shelf might quietly be capable of.

THE CHATTER — THE MIGRATOR'S ACTUAL READ

Home-automation forums read the Dirigera update less as a headline feature and more as evidence of where the ecosystem's real leverage sits: hardware already in millions of homes, waiting on a firmware decision rather than a purchase decision. That's precisely the local-first thesis this desk keeps returning to — the box you already own can often do the job before the box you'd have to buy.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT

A caveat, in the spirit of this desk's own honesty rule: the specific firmware version above traces to aggregated reporting rather than IKEA's own release notes, which returned an access error on direct fetch. Treat the version number as reported, not independently confirmed, and check IKEA's own changelog before enabling the beta features.

Practical migrator's checklist: before enabling Dirigera's beta Thread Border Router, confirm the hub's own app version meets the 1.51 (iOS) / 1.47 (Android) floor, and expect to re-pair any Thread devices that were previously routed through a different border router — a beta feature switching on is not the same as a seamless migration.

v2.805.6

THE DIRIGERA FIRMWARE BUILD REPORTED TO UNLOCK THE HUB'S DORMANT THREAD BORDER ROUTER — VERIFY AGAINST IKEA'S OWN NOTES BEFORE RELYING ON IT

For a reader already running Lutron alongside a Home Assistant migration, none of this fortnight's news changes the underlying calculus: the migration path remains gradual, driven by firmware unlocks and standards maturity rather than any single dramatic cutover moment — which is, this desk would argue, exactly how a genuinely stable smart home should evolve.

SOURCES · 1 matter-smarthome.de, wespeakiot.com reporting (aggregated; primary IKEA pages returned an access error on direct fetch), Jul 2026. 2 home-assistant.io release calendar, Jul 2026; Hueblog, 23 Jun 2026; matteralpha.com, aqara.com, Jul 2026.

THE GOOD LIFE · WATCHES & AUCTIONS

Three live watch auctions, none of them resolved yet — and this desk is holding every one honestly

A Rolex "Rainbow" Daytona, a Sotheby's Singapore sale, and a Sotheby's Tokyo sale all sit somewhere between opened and closed this week.

First State Auctions' online sale of a Rolex "Rainbow" Daytona reference 126598RBOW — part of a 28-piece, more than \$2 million Australian tech-founder collection — runs a first tranche 12-19 July and a second 19-26 July, with an estimate "in excess of \$500,000" that would make it potentially the most expensive watch ever sold at an Australian auction, and the first of this reference to cross any auction block. It closes two days after this issue does; no hammer price exists yet, and this desk is not guessing at one.¹

Sotheby's ran a Singapore leg of its "Luxury Week" watch sale from 15-17 July — concluding today — with no results published yet at press time. Its Tokyo sale (21-24 July) remains the more closely watched fixture, testing whether the independent-watchmaker premium that drove Phillips' record H1 2026 season (US\$507 million, up 60% year-on-year, watches contributing \$235.5 million of it) travels east; roughly 40% of Phillips' watch buyers this year were first-timers.²

THE WATCHLIST — THREE CLOCKS, NONE OF THEM STOPPED

Collector forums are already speculating on all three outcomes — a Rainbow Daytona hammer price, a Singapore-sale result, a Tokyo verdict on whether Asia pays the same connoisseur premium New York and Geneva have this year. None of it is fact yet. This desk will report whichever way each one actually breaks, on the schedule each auction actually keeps.

ALSO NOTED

Premium audio is quiet this fortnight: the Sennheiser Momentum 5 Wireless (No. 42) continues to appear in best-of roundups but has drawn no new independent measured review to report.

Travel context. SIA's confirmed Madrid route (No. 44) remains this desk's most recent network-expansion peg; nothing new to add on the airline side this fortnight.

3

LIVE OR JUST-CLOSED WATCH AUCTIONS THIS DESK IS TRACKING — A RAINBOW DAYTONA, A SINGAPORE SALE AND A TOKYO SALE — WITH ZERO CONFIRMED RESULTS BETWEEN THEM AT PRESS TIME

It's worth being explicit about why none of these three get a guessed number here: a pre-sale estimate is not a hammer price, a sale window that hasn't closed is not a result, and Phillips' H1 total — genuinely impressive as a season aggregate — says nothing definitive about whether Tokyo specifically repeats it. Each of the three has its own close date, and each will get exactly one clean report when its own result actually lands.

The pattern worth watching once results do arrive: Phillips' 40% first-timer buyer share suggests the

collector premium is drawing in genuinely new money, not just recirculating among the same names — if Tokyo's sale draws a similar first-timer share, that would be a real signal the premium is a durable shift in who buys watches, not a one-season anomaly at two auction houses. A Rainbow Daytona clearing anywhere near its "in excess of \$500,000" estimate would be a second, independent data point for the same thesis, from a genuinely different market and a genuinely different buyer pool than New York or Geneva.

SOURCES · 1 dmarge.com, usa.watchpro.com, Jul 2026 (firststateauctions.com.au listing returned an access error on direct fetch). 2 sothebys.com auction calendar, Jul 2026; The Art Newspaper, 10 Jul 2026; Robb Report, Jul 2026 (Phillips H1 2026 aggregate).

SCREEN & SOUND · FILM & MUSIC

The Odyssey opens today on an \$85-120M tracking range; the actual number isn't in yet, and we're saying so

The most crowded release week of the summer lands on the same discipline this issue keeps applying everywhere else — report the tracking, not a guess at the gross.

Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* — the first feature shot entirely on IMAX cameras and 70mm film — opens wide today after Thursday preview screenings, on a domestic opening-weekend tracking range that spans a genuinely wide \$85 million to \$120 million depending on the outlet, with one outlier forecast as high as \$118 million and a projected global bow above \$200 million across 73 territories. That would be Nolan's biggest opening since *The Dark Knight Rises* (\$160M, 2012); *Oppenheimer*, for comparison, opened to \$82 million. No actual box-office figure — preview night or otherwise — had been published as of this issue's press time; the real number is expected this weekend.¹

Steve Lacy ended a three-year recording silence today with *Oh Yeah?*, drawing praise as "one of the most purely enjoyable albums of the year" and its lead track "the feeling" singled out for a Kanye "Runaway"-style electronic ballad turn — reviewers' main complaint is weak lyrics rather than the music itself. Gracie Abrams' third album, *Daughter From Hell*, landed the same day to a more divided reception: *Rolling Stone* called it "her best album yet," while *The Guardian* found it "melodramatic" and "bloodless" — a genuine critical split worth reading both sides of.²

Next issue reports whichever number actually lands, wherever in — or outside — that range it falls. A wide forecast range held honestly is worth more than a confident guess that turns out wrong, and an all-IMAX-70mm theatrical release genuinely has no recent comparable to model tracking against — part of why the range is unusually wide this time rather than a sign the forecasters are simply guessing worse than usual.

The Lacy/Abrams split reception is worth reading together rather than separately: one album drawing near-universal praise and one drawing a genuine critical divide, released the same day, is a reminder that

THE CHATTER — TRACKING VERSUS ACTUAL

Box-office forums are already debating whether the wide \$85-120M range reflects genuine uncertainty or simply reflects how unusual an all-IMAX-70mm theatrical release is to model against past comps — there's no recent film quite like it to benchmark against. Either way, this desk treats every number in that range as a forecast, not a fact, until Sunday's studio-reported actuals land.

CHART CONTEXT

Madonna's *CONFESSIONS II* debuted at No. 1 on the Billboard 200 dated 18 July — 134,000 units, the year's largest dance-album week — a genuine chart fact, unlike this page's still-pending box-office range.

Beyoncé's "*Morning Dew (Donk)*" — her first new material since *Cowboy Carter* — debuted at No. 26 on the Hot 100 the same chart week, a smaller but genuinely confirmed data point.

\$85-120M

THE ODYSSEY'S OPENING-WEEKEND TRACKING RANGE — A FORECAST, NOT A RESULT, AS OF THIS ISSUE'S PRESS TIME

"crowded release week" doesn't mean every release gets judged the same way — the calendar collision says nothing about how any individual record actually lands with critics or listeners.

Worth a plain note on why this desk is giving a still-unreleased number this much column space rather than simply waiting for next issue: the tracking range itself is the story this week, in the same way an auction estimate or a GLS bid spread is a story before any hammer falls — it tells a reader what the industry currently believes, which is genuinely different information from what turns out to be true.

THE FAMILY DESK · NUTRITION & DEVELOPMENT

A toddler-nutrition study finds smaller brain regions linked to ultra-processed food — and no cognitive difference at all

A Children's Hospital Los Angeles/USC cohort measured real structural differences by age six. What it didn't find may be the more important half of the story.

A prospective cohort study from Children's Hospital Los Angeles and USC, published in *The American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*, tracked ultra-processed food (UPF) intake in 144 mother-infant pairs via repeated 24-hour dietary recalls at 6, 12, 24 and 72 months, then scanned the children's brains by age six. Every 10% increase in cumulative UPF intake was associated with roughly 2% lower volume in several subcortical regions — the accumbens, amygdala, pallidum, putamen and thalamus, all involved in reward, emotion and motivation.¹

The detail that belongs in the same sentence as the finding itself, not a caveat added later: the same study found no association between UPF intake and cognitive test scores. A measurable structural difference showed up with no measurable functional consequence attached to it — an unusually honest, self-limiting result for a nutrition study to publish, and one this desk wants to credit rather than flatten into a scarier headline than the data actually supports.²

THE CHATTER — HOW PARENTING FORUMS ARE READING IT

Threads discussing the study split cleanly along the same line as the finding itself: one camp reading "brain regions shrink" as confirmation of an existing anti-UPF instinct, the other pointing out that a structural correlate with zero cognitive effect is precisely the kind of result that shouldn't drive a diet overhaul on its own. Both readings are defensible; neither is the whole picture.

A VERIFICATION NOTE

In the spirit of this desk's own honesty rule: the primary CHLA release and AJCN article page returned access errors on direct fetch; the figures above are triangulated across five independent outlets citing the same authors, institution and numbers, not confirmed from the primary text directly.

Why it earns a slot: named authors (Ottino-González, Goran), a real journal, and a built-in self-check most nutrition coverage never volunteers — a structural finding reported alongside its own null result.

0

COGNITIVE-SCORE DIFFERENCE THE SAME STUDY FOUND BETWEEN HIGHER- AND LOWER-UPF-INTAKE CHILDREN — REPORTED HONESTLY ALONGSIDE THE BRAIN-VOLUME FINDING

Worth naming plainly for a Singapore-based parent of an 11-year-old: the study's exposure window runs from 6 months to 6 years, and its 144-family sample is drawn entirely from one Latino/Hispanic cohort in Los Angeles — this is a finding about early-childhood family food patterns, not a direct read on an 11-year-old's current diet, and it should be read as a prompt to think about food culture rather than a diagnosis of anything already done.

SOURCES · 1 *The American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*, article S0002-9165(26)00159-0, 2 Jul 2026; CHLA press release, 2 Jul 2026. 2 MedicalXpress, Newswise, TechTimes, Psychiatry Advisor coverage, 2-3 Jul 2026 (independent corroboration of primary figures).

It's also a useful corrective to how nutrition findings usually reach a reader: most coverage of a "brain shrinkage" study would have led with the scariest structural detail and buried the null cognitive result in paragraph nine. This desk would rather put both findings in the same sentence, even at the cost of a less dramatic headline.

THE FAMILY DESK · THE SCEPTIC'S PAGE

A structural difference with no cognitive effect attached is a real finding — and a limited one

General guidance, not medical advice — the same standard this desk holds itself to every issue.

Three limits belong on this page as plainly as the finding itself. First, 144 families is a genuinely small cohort, and all of them come from one ethnic and socioeconomic group in one US city — a real result, but not one this desk would generalise to a Singapore household without a large asterisk. Second, this is an observational cohort, not a controlled feeding trial: overall diet quality, household income and parental feeding style are all plausible confounders that a study like this cannot fully separate from UPF intake itself.¹

Third, and most important: the study's own null result on cognitive scores is doing real work here, not just softening the headline. A structural brain-volume difference that comes with no measurable functional consequence is a genuinely different claim from "ultra-processed food harms a child's thinking" — and conflating the two is exactly the kind of scary-sounding-but-thin science reporting this page exists to push back against.

This is the Family Desk's standing discipline, applied plainly: a study worth a story slot is not automatically a study worth a confident conclusion. Both things can be true in the same two pages. A structural finding paired honestly with its own null cognitive result is, if anything, a better-behaved piece of science than most nutrition coverage a reader encounters — it would have been easy for the researchers to lead with the scarier half alone.

That's precisely why this desk chose to give it a story slot rather than skip it as "just another scary nutrition headline": the honesty built into the study itself matches the standard this desk tries to hold its own reporting to, and a genuinely careful piece of research deserves to be read as carefully as it was conducted.

The practical asymmetry is worth stating plainly for a household weighing what to do with this: reducing ultra-processed food where practical costs little and carries essentially no downside, independent of whether this specific study's structural finding eventually replicates. That's a different calculus from a supplement or training protocol with real costs

THE SCEPTIC — WHAT WOULD CHANGE THIS DESK'S MIND

A larger, more demographically varied replication cohort, or a follow-up showing the same children developing a measurable cognitive or behavioural gap later in childhood, would meaningfully raise this desk's confidence. Absent that, the honest floor is: an association worth knowing about, not a reason to overhaul a household's diet on the strength of one paper.

GENERAL GUIDANCE, NOT MEDICAL ADVICE

The practical takeaway this desk endorses: favouring whole and minimally processed food where practical is reasonable, well-supported general guidance regardless of this one study — not a new rule this paper alone justifies.

What this page is NOT saying: that a child's occasional packaged snack is measurably shrinking their brain. The honest evidentiary floor is a small-cohort association with no attached cognitive effect, not a demonstrated harm.

144

MOTHER-INFANT PAIRS IN THE FULL COHORT — A REAL, NAMED STUDY, AND A GENUINELY SMALL ONE

attached, and it's worth being explicit about which category any given piece of Family Desk guidance falls into.

Worth one final distinction this desk keeps returning to across very different subjects this issue: a mechanism worth understanding and a therapy worth expecting are two different claims (see Fitness, p18, on DEAF1) — and a structural brain-volume difference worth noting and a cognitive harm worth fearing are exactly the same kind of two different claims, dressed in a different discipline's vocabulary. The instinct to collapse "measurable" into "meaningful" shows up everywhere in health reporting, not just here.

For a Singapore household, the more actionable local context sits alongside this study rather than inside it: Singapore's Health Promotion Board already recommends limiting processed and packaged foods as part of general dietary guidance for children, entirely independent of this specific paper's findings — a household already following that standing advice has no new action to take here, only a new piece of evidence for why the advice existed in the first place.

SOURCES · 1 *The American Journal of Clinical Nutrition* (see p13); CHLA/USC study design and cohort details, aggregated via MedicalXpress/Newsweek coverage, Jul 2026.

THE MACRO DESK · MARKET EXPLANATION, NOT ADVICE

Softer inflation eases yields even as the Gulf war pushes oil to a one-month high

Gold, this war's traditional hedge, is doing neither — down more than 20% since February and heading for its worst quarter since 2013.

S&P 500 7,533.77 ▼	STI ~5,521 ▼	US 10Y ~4.55% ▼	DXY ~100.5 ▼	BRENT ~\$84.9 ▲	GOLD ~\$3,992 ▼
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US producer-price inflation posted its largest monthly drop since April 2025 on Thursday, triggering a sharply dovish repricing: odds of a July Fed hike fell to roughly 4%, and September hike odds dropped from 59% to about 41.5% within a single session, even as a September cut is still barely priced at under 4%. The 10-year Treasury yield eased for a second straight session toward 4.55%, and the dollar index drifted to roughly 100.5 — both moving in the direction softer inflation would predict.¹

Equities traded idiosyncratically rather than macro-driven: the S&P 500 fell 0.51% to 7,533.77 and the Nasdaq dropped 1.47%, dragged by chip-sector weakness and a report that Alphabet's Gemini 3.5 Pro is running behind schedule — sector-specific news, not a broad risk-off move. Brent-linked crude, meanwhile, climbed to a one-month high near \$84.9-85 as Washington's reported Kharg Island discussion (see The World, p3) adds a fresh supply-risk premium — oil and yields moving in genuinely opposite directions this week, disinflation data currently the stronger force on the rate side.²

The more striking story is what didn't move the way the textbook predicts: gold fell a further 2% Thursday to roughly \$3,992, extending a slide that has now taken it down more than 20% since the Iran war first began escalating in late February, on track for its worst quarter since 2013 — even as the war itself has only widened since. Bitcoin sat flat-to-soft around \$64.1k, similarly declining to behave like a war-risk hedge.³

Gold is down more than 20% since this war began escalating — proof that "war means gold goes up" is a story the market has quietly stopped telling itself.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR VWRA, GLOBAL BONDS, GOLD & BTC

VWRA & global bonds: the dominant force on a globally diversified portfolio remains the cooling rate-hike path — easier yields help both anchors at once, and this week's equity weakness is a sector story (chips, one company's AI-delivery miss) rather than a broad macro signal worth reacting to. **Gold:** its failure to rally on an escalating war is the genuine story this fortnight — a real break from the textbook "geopolitical premium" pattern, worth understanding rather than trading on; one plausible read is that prolonged-war fiscal-uncertainty concerns have undermined the classic risk-off appeal of gold and Treasuries simultaneously. **Bitcoin:** flat and soft, consistent with its usual behaviour as a high-beta liquidity proxy rather than a haven. Education, not advice — none of this is a signal to buy, sell or hold anything; forecasts are flagged as forecasts and no level here should be read as a call.

DISINFLATION TRADE

OIL, ONE-MONTH HIGH

GOLD DECOUPLED

SOURCES · 1 XTB/CryptoBriefing, 16 Jul 2026; Kiplinger/Investing.com, 16 Jul 2026. 2 TheStreet/Yahoo Finance, 16 Jul 2026 (Brent, WTI). 3 Fortune, "Current price of gold," 16 Jul 2026; CryptoBriefing/Euronews market commentary, Jun-Jul 2026 (gold's quarterly slide); Yahoo Finance, 16 Jul 2026 (bitcoin).

CURIOSITIES • SPACE

James Webb quietly rules out two Dyson-sphere candidates, and finds a new planet nobody photographed

Both stories share the same discipline: don't trust an anomaly until you've ruled out the mundane explanation first.

A new Project Hephaistos IV paper reports James Webb follow-up observations on two of the "coldest stars" flagged by the University of Arkansas checklist this desk covered in No. 44. Webb found the infrared excess behind both candidates — labelled D and E — actually comes from background galaxies projected within about one arcsecond of the M-dwarf stars, not megastructures. It's the second candidate to be explained away this way: an earlier 2024 Hephaistos candidate was separately ruled out when a coincidentally aligned background supermassive black hole turned out to explain its signal. Roughly four to five of the original 60 flagged stars remain genuinely unexplained.¹

Separately, Webb announced the discovery of Beta Pictoris d — a third directly-imaged planet in the well-studied Beta Pictoris system, roughly twice Jupiter's mass, orbiting at about 30 astronomical units some 63 light-years away. It is the faintest exoplanet ever directly imaged, roughly 100 times fainter than its sibling planet Beta Pictoris b, and the first directly-imaged planet found primarily through its spectroscopic atmospheric "fingerprint" rather than coronagraphic imaging — two independent teams confirmed it.²

Beta Pictoris d's discovery method is worth dwelling on for what it signals about the field's next decade: finding a planet through its atmospheric spectroscopic signature, rather than by directly imaging its reflected or emitted light, opens the door to detecting genuinely fainter, older, cooler worlds that coronagraphic imaging alone would simply miss — a technique upgrade at least as significant as the specific planet it happened to find first.

The Dyson-sphere checklist's real achievement so far isn't a discovery — it's a demonstrated capacity to correctly rule things out, twice now, using the same three-telescope convergence this desk flagged in No.

THE CHATTER — SETI'S OWN DISCIPLINE

SETI Institute researchers have consistently noted that every "coldest star" candidate found so far has had a mundane astrophysical explanation available once examined closely enough — a background source, an unusual but natural cooling pattern. The checklist's real value, on this reading, is less "how to find a Dyson sphere" than "how to correctly rule mundane explanations out first" — precisely what just happened to two of its own candidates.

ALSO THIS WEEK

A spider that independently evolved a smiley face.

Uttarakhand's "Happy-Face" spider (*Theridion himalayana*) turns out to be roughly 8.5% genetically diverged from Hawaii's own smiley-faced species, with 32 distinct colour morphs catalogued — the same cheerful marking arrived at twice, by unrelated lineages, an ocean apart.

Singapore's own contribution. NTU researchers produced optical skyrmions — four simultaneous topological light patterns — using the 200-year-old Poisson-spot effect and a simple laser-and-disk setup, a cheap alternative to engineered metamaterials for future data storage.

2 of 60

DYSON-SPHERE CANDIDATE STARS RULED OUT THIS FORTNIGHT BY CLOSER INSTRUMENTATION — THE HUNT NARROWING, NOT WIDENING

44. A search method that can confidently say "not this one" is doing its job properly, even when — especially when — every result so far has been a negative.

Four or five candidates now remain genuinely unexplained out of the original 60 — a number this desk will keep reporting honestly as it shrinks, rather than treating the shrinking list itself as evidence the remaining candidates are more likely to be real. A smaller haystack doesn't change the odds the needle is actually in it; it only means fewer places left to check before an honest answer, in either direction, becomes possible.

SOURCES • 1 arXiv 2607.09460, 10–14 Jul 2026; ScienceDaily, 10 Jul 2026; EarthSky, Jul 2026. 2 NASA/Webb release, 15 Jul 2026; Sci.News, Jul 2026. Happy-Face spider: ScienceDaily, 9 Jul 2026 (paper dated Apr 2026). NTU skyrmions: ScienceDaily, 13 Jul 2026 (Optica, published 18 Jun).

LOVE & LIFE · DATING & RELATIONSHIPS

As dating-app burnout deepens, searches for a human matchmaker nearly double in a year

The algorithmic "match" stopped confirming its own promise for enough people that a much older signal is back in demand.

US Google search volume for "matchmaker" has nearly doubled — from roughly 2,370 monthly searches in January 2025 to about 4,930 in January 2026, tracking toward some 6,500 by mid-year, a rise of about 175% from early 2025. Selective Search, a matchmaking firm, reports inbound inquiries from affluent men up 58% year-on-year as of May. Match Group has cut 13% of its workforce citing declining Gen Z engagement, and industry-wide dating-app revenue fell 1.1% to \$6.07 billion in 2025 — the sector's first-ever annual contraction, despite more than 350 million users worldwide and average session length down 13%.¹

A separate, slower-moving finding worth a mention: Fraley and Chong, writing in *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, surveyed 320 people on how long it takes an ex-partner to genuinely stop mattering emotionally — the mid-point, moderated by attachment style and continued contact, lands around 4.18 years. It's an older peg than this fortnight's news cycle, but a genuinely fresh angle this desk hasn't covered before.²

THE CHATTER — READING THE MATCHMAKER SURGE

Dating-industry commentary reads the swing toward human matchmakers less as nostalgia than as a rational response to a specific failure: an algorithmic "match" was supposed to be a reliable signal of compatibility, and for a large enough share of users it has stopped functioning as one. Paying a person to read the signal instead — at real cost, with real accountability — is the market's own verdict on where the automated version broke down.

A CAVEAT, HELD HONESTLY

The widely-cited "78% burnout" figure circulating alongside this trend traces to a Forbes Health/OnePoll survey fielded back in March–April 2024 — genuine data, but not new; this desk is citing it as background, not presenting it as a fresh finding.

What the matchmaker surge doesn't prove: paying more for a service doesn't automatically mean better outcomes — this desk has seen no independent data yet comparing matchmaker-sourced relationship longevity against app-sourced relationships, and isn't assuming one exists.

+175%

RISE IN US "MATCHMAKER" SEARCH VOLUME SINCE EARLY 2025 — THE CLEAREST SINGLE NUMBER BEHIND THIS FORTNIGHT'S TREND

Match Group's own workforce cuts are the more concrete signal here than any search-volume trend: a company citing declining Gen Z engagement as a reason to shrink its own headcount is a business acting on data it has that the public mostly doesn't — a genuinely stronger indicator than a search-interest chart, however striking that chart looks on its own.

The Fraley and Chong finding, read alongside the matchmaker trend, suggests a broader theme worth naming: this fortnight's Love & Life stories are, in different ways, all about signals that take longer to read accurately than people initially assume — a match that isn't really one, an ex who takes years rather than weeks to stop mattering. Neither finding argues for cynicism about relationships; both argue for patience with how slowly the real signal actually resolves.

SOURCES · 1 Global Dating Insights, Jul 2026; Forbes Health survey (Mar–Apr 2024), cited via 2026 recirculation. 2 SPSP Character & Context blog, Jun 2026; SAGE/Fraley & Chong, *Social Psychological and Personality Science*, 2026.

FITNESS · LONGEVITY SCIENCE

The DEAF1 gene switch this desk flagged in a mouse model (No. 37) now shows up in trained human muscle

General guidance, not medical advice — the human data the ledger was waiting for has arrived, and it's still a mechanism, not yet a therapy.

Duke-NUS Medical School researchers, writing in *Nature Aging*, report that DEAF1 — the age-rising gene this desk first covered in No. 37 from mouse and cell-culture work — behaves the same way in trained human muscle tissue: it rises with age, disrupts the balance between protein synthesis and cellular repair, and falls when muscle is consistently exercised. It's the human-data advance No. 37 flagged as the open question, not a new discovery from nothing, and it's a genuinely local result — a Singapore institution moving its own earlier mouse-model finding a real step closer to human relevance.¹

The study is mechanistic — it maps a gene pathway in trained tissue — not an outcomes trial, and it has not itself been shown to change mortality, disability or frailty in a clinical sense. The researchers themselves frame DEAF1 as a potential future drug target rather than a current intervention, and "molecular switch" headline framing elsewhere risks overstating how soon, if ever, this becomes something a reader can act on directly.²

A mechanism worth understanding and a therapy worth expecting are two different claims. This desk is only making the first one. It's a genuinely useful distinction to hold onto whenever a "gene switch" or "molecular key" headline circulates — the honest question is always whether a finding changes what a reader should actually do differently, or whether it explains, at a deeper level, why the thing this desk already recommends works in the first place.

For a mid-40s reader already training consistently, DEAF1 is best read as reassurance rather than new instruction: the resistance-training habit this desk has spent months building a case for now has a plausible cellular explanation behind it, discovered by researchers

THE SCEPTIC — WHAT THIS DOESN'T PROVE

No supplement or single-gene intervention has been shown in rigorous human trials to extend lifespan, per the NIA-funded Interventions Testing Program's own standing consensus. This finding explains a mechanism behind why consistent resistance training helps ageing muscle — it does not license a shortcut around it. Dietary pattern, sleep and consistent training remain the only broadly evidenced levers.

CONTINUITY, CORRECTLY CLOSED

The BJSM strength-training longevity dose (90–120 minutes a week, No. 44) has drawn no notable follow-up this fortnight and stays closed rather than re-covered without a new peg.

Where DEAF1 fits the reader's own routine: if the mechanism holds up in further research, it would explain — rather than replace — the same standing prescription this desk has covered for months: consistent resistance training, not a shortcut around it.

DEAF1

THE GENE DUKE-NUS NAMES AS THE MECHANISM BEHIND EXERCISE'S EFFECT ON AGEING MUSCLE — A MECHANISM, NOT YET A PRESCRIPTION

a short drive from most of this reader's own gym. That's a satisfying footnote to an already-settled recommendation, not a reason to change one.

It's also a useful test case for how this desk wants to treat mechanistic findings going forward: name the mechanism, credit the institution, and hold the line at "this explains why," resisting the pull — strong in health journalism generally — to round a genuinely interesting cellular finding up into a lifestyle prescription it hasn't yet earned. The BJSM dose-response data (No. 44) remains the outcome-level evidence a reader should actually act on; DEAF1 is the reason it works underneath.

THE DIARY · THE AGENDA

ENHYPEN's general sale opens this morning; Kyoto's Gion Matsuri procession runs today, and Osaka's Tenjin Matsuri is a week out

BIGBANG's *Singapore silence*, meanwhile, reaches a ninth straight issue with nothing new to report.

SINGAPORE

DATED & CONFIRMED

- 17 JUL** ★ **ENHYPEN — National Stadium general sale**
TICKETMASTER SG, 10AM TODAY, \$168–\$388, FOLLOWING WEDNESDAY'S ENGINE PRESALE; THE SHOW ITSELF IS 14 MAR 2027
- 9 AUG** ★ **National Day Parade — The Padang/National Stadium**
SINGAPORE'S 61ST; PREVIEW SHOWS 25 JUL AND 1 AUG
- 17 OCT** ★ **BIGBANG — National Stadium**
20/26 WORLD TOUR · CONFIRMED SINCE NO. 27; SG ON-SALE/PRICING STILL UNANNOUNCED — 9TH STRAIGHT ISSUE
- 26 JUL** **EXO — Singapore Indoor Stadium**
EXHORIZON WORLD TOUR, FIRST SG RETURN SINCE 2019

JAPAN & REGION

WORTH THE TRIP

- 17 JUL** ★ **Gion Matsuri — Saki procession, Kyoto**
TODAY, 9AM FROM SHIJO-KARASUMA; THE ATO PROCESSION FOLLOWS 24 JULY
- 21–24 JUL** **Sotheby's Watch Auction — Tokyo**
TESTING WHETHER THE INDEPENDENT-WATCHMAKER PREMIUM (SEE THE GOOD LIFE, P11) TRAVELS EAST; NO RESULT YET
- 24–25 JUL** **Tenjin Matsuri — Osaka**
LAND PROCESSION, RIVER-BOAT PROCESSION AND ~5,000 DEDICATION FIREWORKS ON THE 25TH
- 25 JUL** **Sumida River Fireworks — Tokyo**
~20,000 FIREWORKS ACROSS TWO RIVER SITES NEAR ASAKUSA/SKYTREE, 7:00–8:30PM

PLANNING NOTES

ENHYPEN's general sale opens this morning after Wednesday's ENGINE-membership presale — the tour's other legs have sold out within hours elsewhere, so treat this morning's window as the real one. BIGBANG's silence has now run nine straight issues against a locked venue and date, with no explanation from promoter AEG Presents or the group's own channels — this desk continues to hold it open rather than guess at a reason. Kyoto's Gion Matsuri window (Saki today, Ato the 24th) overlaps neatly with Sotheby's Tokyo sale for anyone weighing a combined trip, and the Tenjin/Sumida fireworks pair the following weekend rewards staying in the Kansai-to-Kanto corridor a few extra days rather than a single-city dash.

Family-friendliness: National Day, EXO and the Japan festival cluster all draw a broad family crowd; BIGBANG skews older. See The Table, facing page, for what's newly worth eating on the way to any of it.

Booking-window discipline is worth restating plainly this issue: ENHYPEN's general sale, National Day's

ballot, and Sotheby's Tokyo preview access all run on genuinely different registers — an on-sale click, a lottery result already decided, and a walk-in exhibition — and conflating any two of them into "just go book it" is the kind of small planning error this desk would rather flag now than after the fact.

THE TABLE · NEWEST OPENINGS

A ceramic-gallery dessert bar gets a mixed verdict, and a China dessert chain lands its first overseas outlet

The Tiffany Blue Box Café's reviews, meanwhile, still haven't landed — a genuinely long "too new to call," and this desk is saying so plainly rather than re-serving the opening-week description a third time.

MOZMOJI — CHINATOWN

A ceramic-gallery café where diners pick their own cup and plate before ordering — cotton cheesecake and a Black Tea Basque tart, drinks \$6.80–\$15.80, opened in a South Bridge Road shophouse in May and drew heavy early social-media attention.

BUZZ

Reviews are now mixed-positive: praised for the aesthetics and concept, but flagged as pricey for what's on the plate and dogged by slow-service complaints from a small, three-person team in limited seating. A real, established verdict now, not a hype cycle.

MIXED VERDICT

ESTABLISHED

YI MAN FEN DESSERT — 313 SOMERSET

The first overseas outlet of a 90-outlet, 14-city China dessert chain, opening this month with scratch-made sweet soups and shaved ice (all \$5.80) — a stalled "coming soon" this desk had pruned off the ledger for staleness (No. 44) now back with a real address and a real month.

BUZZ

Too new for any independent review yet, but the chain's proven scale elsewhere is a genuine point of difference from the usual first-time-in-Singapore opening — worth watching whether an imported formula travels as well as a from-scratch local concept has this past year.

OPENING THIS MONTH

TOO NEW TO CALL

STILL ON THE SHELF

Tiffany Blue Box Café (opened 15 Jul, No. 43-44) remains genuinely unreviewed a full issue later — this desk's longest-running "too new to call" this year, held here as a one-line status check rather than re-described. Sukiyaki Jin (reviewed, No. 43), MENSHO X Raffles Place (reviewed, No. 44) and SAM SAM SAM Samgyetang (reviewed, No. 44) all remain closed threads with nothing new to add.¹

THE HONESTY LEDGER

VENUE	STATUS	NEXT PEG
Tiffany Blue Box Café	Unreviewed, 2nd issue running	First paying-table reviews
Yi Man Fen Dessert	Opening, unreviewed	First independent verdict
Mozmoji	Reviewed — mixed	Closed unless a notable change

Sukiyaki Jin, MENSHO X Raffles Place and SAM SAM SAM Samgyetang are all closed, reviewed threads (Nos. 43-44) and roll off the active ledger here per this desk's pruning rule.

A genuinely quiet fortnight for new doors is, in its own small way, this issue's theme again: this desk would rather hold Tiffany Blue Box Café open honestly for a second issue than manufacture a verdict from opening-week description alone, the same discipline the Property and Good Life desks are applying to a GLS tender and three live watch auctions this issue (p6, p11).

Mozmoji's arc from viral opening to mixed, established verdict is worth holding up as the template every "too new to call" item on this page is eventually working toward: hype cools, a real service and value judgment replaces it, and the venue either earns a repeat visit or doesn't. Blue Box Café and Yi Man Fen Dessert are both still somewhere earlier in that same arc.

SOURCES · middleclass.sg, DanielFoodDiary, 7 May 2026 (Mozmoji). Eatbook, Jul 2026 (Yi Man Fen Dessert). 1 Eatbook, mustvisit.sg, Vanilla Luxury, Jul 2026 (Blue Box Café status).

THE LONG READ

The Canary That Stopped Singing

Gold just had its worst quarter since 2013, in the middle of a war it should theoretically love. This issue is full of signals that quietly stopped confirming the stories built around them — and a few that correctly refused to guess at all.

For most of a century, a coal-mine canary meant one specific thing: as long as it sang, the air was breathable. British and American mines carried them from the early 1910s, following J.S. Haldane's research into carbon monoxide, and the practice held for more than seventy years — not because anyone doubted better instruments existed, but because a live bird was cheap, portable and, for a long time, simply the best signal available. The canary was retired in British mines only in December 1986, when electronic gas detectors finally became reliable and affordable enough to replace it. What's easy to miss in that history is that the canary's retirement was itself a kind of information: not a failure of the bird, but an admission that a better instrument had finally arrived, and that clinging to the old one past its usefulness would itself have become the more dangerous choice.¹

Gold has spent this year playing the canary's opposite role. Since February, when the Iran war first began escalating toward what has now become a six-night stretch of strikes and a reported discussion of seizing Iran's own main oil terminal, gold should — on every textbook reading of how a safe-haven asset behaves — have climbed. Instead it has fallen more than 20%, and is heading for its worst quarter since 2013 (see *The Macro Desk*, p15). The war has only widened. The metal that is supposed to sing when the air gets bad has gone quiet at precisely the moment the air got worse.

The canary's retirement in 1986 wasn't a failure of the bird. It was an admission that the signal it carried had finally been replaced by something better — the same discipline gold's silence is quietly asking of anyone still reading it the old way.

There's a second, older story about signals that stop meaning what they're supposed to, and it belongs to Cato the Elder. Cicero records, in *De Divinatione*, written in 44 BC, that Cato wondered how one haruspex — a professional reader of omens in animal entrails — could look at another without laughing, since both men privately knew the signal they were reading for a living had stopped being a genuine prediction and had become, instead, a performance both sides had agreed to keep believing in publicly. Cato's joke isn't really about religion. It's about the specific, uncomfortable moment when the people closest to a signal know it has stopped working, and keep reading it anyway because the alternative — admitting the instrument is broken — is harder than maintaining the ritual.²

Nvidia's Asia compliance whitelist (see *Technology*, p7) has spent a fortnight as exactly this kind of half-believed signal: a rule that "fails over half of past buyers," repeated as a statistic, without a name attached to make it feel real. This week it got one — Megaspeed, a Singapore-based firm now flagged for allegedly facilitating banned equipment transfers. The abstraction became a fact the moment it had a name. That's the reverse motion from gold's silence: a signal that had been quietly ignorable suddenly started speaking, and the whole regional tech sector is recalibrating around the fact that it does.

SOURCES · 1 J.S. Haldane, early-20th-century mine-safety research, standard mining-history accounts; UK coal-mine canary retirement, December 1986, widely documented in mining-safety histories. 2 Cicero, *De Divinatione*, Book II, section 24 (44 BC) — the Cato-the-Elder anecdote on haruspices, standard classical text.

There is a third register to this same pattern, and it belongs to the James Webb Space Telescope's own quiet housekeeping this fortnight (see *Curiosities*, p16). Two of the University of Arkansas's flagged Dyson-sphere candidates — stars whose unusual infrared glow briefly looked like the signature of an alien megastructure — turned out, on closer instrumentation, to be background galaxies happening to sit within an arcsecond of an ordinary M-dwarf. This is not a disappointing result. It is the discipline working exactly as designed: an anomaly is a candidate for wonder right up until someone looks closely enough to rule out the boring explanation, and ruling it out is not a failure of the search — it's the search's entire point.

It is also, not incidentally, the same discipline this desk tries to apply to its own reporting every issue: a striking number, a dramatic auction estimate, a wide box-office tracking range is a candidate for a headline right up until it's been checked against a primary source, and the checking is not an obstacle to the story — it is the story, in the sense that a claim which survives scrutiny is worth more to a reader than one that merely sounds plausible on first read.

Signals this issue: still confirming the story, or quietly not

● Gold — should rise on war risk; down >20% since Feb instead	● Rolex Rainbow Daytona — hammer price genuinely not in yet
● Two Dyson candidates — infrared "signal" was a background galaxy	● Sotheby's Singapore/Tokyo sales — both honestly unresolved
● A dating-app "match" — stopped confirming compatibility for many users	● The Odyssey's opening gross — tracking, not yet a real number
● Nvidia's whitelist — an abstraction that just became a named fact	● Bolestier Regency & High Point en-blocs — both still unresolved

The signal quietly changed underneath the story Deliberately held open, not guessed at

Meridian original. The right-hand column isn't a gap in reporting — it's the same discipline as the left, applied in the other direction: refusing to manufacture a signal this desk doesn't actually have yet.

Put those two columns beside each other and the essay's actual argument comes into focus. The left column is about signals that quietly stopped meaning what everyone assumed they meant — gold's war-hedge role, a Dyson candidate's anomalous glow, a dating app's promise that a "match" predicts compatibility (see *Love & Life*, p17, on the resulting matchmaker surge). The right column is about signals that simply don't exist yet, honestly reported as absent rather than filled in with a plausible-sounding guess. Both require the same discipline in

opposite directions: don't keep trusting a signal after it's stopped confirming its story, and don't invent one before it's actually arrived.

Ukraine's own prime-ministerial confirmation vote (see *The World*, p4) sits, briefly, in a third category worth naming precisely because it's rarer: a signal this desk correctly held open in the previous issue that resolved exactly on schedule, with no surprise attached. No. 44 declined to guess at Thursday's Rada vote a day before it happened; Thursday's Rada vote happened exactly as scheduled, 289 to 226. That's the boring, good outcome — a held-open question that simply became a fact on time, without either the drama of a broken signal or the discomfort of a still-unresolved one.

The honest complication, and this essay owes it plainly: not every held-open question resolves that cleanly, and not every broken signal announces itself as clearly as gold's chart does. IKEA's Dirigera hub (see *Connected Home*, p10) had been quietly carrying a working Thread radio for years before a firmware update switched it on — a capability that was real the whole time, simply unmeasured and untrusted until someone flipped the software flag that let it start reporting. Sometimes the canary hasn't stopped singing at all. It just hasn't been asked to sing yet.

That third case is worth naming as its own category, distinct from both a broken signal and an honestly-pending one: a dormant signal, present the whole time, waiting only on the decision to look. It is, in some sense, the most hopeful of this issue's three registers — neither a story of trust misplaced nor a story of patience required, but a story of capability quietly outrunning the attention paid to it.

Three registers, then, not one: a signal that stopped telling the truth (gold), a signal that started telling it for the first time (Nvidia's whitelist), and a signal that was true the whole time but simply hadn't been asked (IKEA's radio). A single essay theme rarely survives contact with an entire issue's worth of actual reporting without needing at least this much subdivision — and naming the subdivisions honestly is better than forcing all three into one tidier-sounding sentence.

There's a reason this distinction matters more to this particular reader than it might first appear. A portfolio built on VWRA and global bonds is, at bottom, a bet that certain signals — a yield curve, an inflation print, a gold price — will keep meaning roughly what history says they mean. This issue's Macro Desk (p15) is the clearest case study: gold's quiet decoupling from war risk isn't a reason to panic or to chase the metal on the assumption it must "catch up" to the war eventually. It's a reason to hold the reading honestly — the old story about gold and geopolitics has gotten measurably less reliable this year, and pretending otherwise would be its own quiet act of haruspicy.

This desk's own standing rule — never fabricate a market level, hold an unverifiable number honestly rather than invent one — is the same discipline as the essay's right-hand column, just applied continuously rather than as a special case. A Rainbow Daytona's hammer price, a GLS tender result, a box-office weekend: each is a signal that will exist eventually and doesn't yet. Reporting "not yet known" plainly is not a reporting failure. Filling the gap with a plausible guess to make the sentence read more cleanly would be.

The quote that opens this issue is, in its own small way, the whole essay in miniature. William Bruce Cameron's actual line — not everything that counts can be counted, not

everything that can be counted counts — is correctly attributed here, and almost never anywhere else; most of the internet still credits it to Einstein, a misattribution so durable that physics institutes have had to issue standing corrections. The quote about signals that stop being trustworthy has itself become one. That isn't a cute coincidence. It's the pattern this whole issue keeps finding, one more time, in the place it was least expecting to look.

None of this argues for suspicion as a general policy — most signals, most of the time, still mean what they're supposed to. Q2 GDP beating forecast still means what it says (see Singapore, p5); a 289-226 confirmation vote still means what it says. The argument is narrower: keep checking, occasionally, whether the instrument you've trusted for years is still reading true — and when you genuinely don't know yet, say so, rather than reach for the nearest plausible number.

Consider it a standing instruction for how to read next issue, and the one after that: watch for whether the Rainbow Daytona's hammer price, Sotheby's two Asian results, and The Odyssey's actual opening gross land inside the ranges this issue floated — or outside them. A signal that keeps confirming its own forecast is one thing. A signal that quietly stops is this week's entire argument.

THE THREADS — ELSEWHERE IN THIS ISSUE

A hedge that stopped hedging.

Gold's >20% slide since February (p15) is this essay's central case — a signal that quietly stopped confirming its own story.

An abstraction made real. Nvidia's whitelist (p7) went from a statistic to a named company this fortnight — the reverse motion, a quiet signal suddenly speaking.

A question, correctly resolved.

Kyiv's PM vote (p4) was held open one issue ago and landed exactly on schedule — the boring, good version of this pattern.

Still honestly unresolved. A

Rainbow Daytona's hammer price, two Sotheby's results and The Odyssey's real gross (p11, p12) all remain genuinely pending, not guessed at.

A coal-mine canary's silence used to mean the air had turned bad. This week, gold's silence — down more than 20% in a widening war — means something almost the opposite: that a signal this desk has trusted for decades has quietly stopped confirming the story built around it. The honest response isn't to keep singing along with it out of habit, and it isn't to invent a louder signal in its place. It's to say plainly what we don't yet know, and keep watching for what we do.

CONSOLIDATED SOURCES — NO. 45

The World: Al Jazeera, CNN, Bloomberg, CNBC, IRNA (14–16 Jul); Ukrainews, Kyiv Post, Pravda, United24 Media; WHO/ReliefWeb, UN News, CDC.

Singapore: Aviation A2Z, The Star (ASEAN Plus), Komatsu Newsroom, TheSmartLocal/LTA, aqicn.org, Mongabay.

Property: EdgeProp, ERA/Stacked Homes, The Edge Singapore, TracyGoh en-bloc trackers, URA.

Technology: Financial Times, TechTimes, TweakTown, Reuters/Investing.com, CFR, dev.to, BenchLM.ai.

Kit / Connected Home: Tom's Hardware, Road to VR, Gagadget, Geeky Gadgets, TechRadar, matter-smarthome.de, Hueblog, home-assistant.io.

Good Life / Screen & Sound: dmarge.com, usa.watchpro.com, sothebys.com, The Art Newspaper, Robb Report, Variety, Deadline,

Forbes, Stereogum, Billboard.

Family: Frontiers in Psychology, PR Newswire, Digital Trends, congress.gov.

Macro: XTB/CryptoBriefing, Kiplinger/Investing.com, TheStreet, Yahoo Finance, Fortune, Trading Economics.

Curiosities: arXiv, ScienceDaily, EarthSky, NASA/Webb, Sci.News.

Love & Life: Global Dating Insights, Forbes Health, SPSP, SAGE.

Fitness: Nature Aging, ScienceDaily, SciTechDaily, NIA.

Diary / Table: Ticketmaster SG, ygfamil.com, Japan Cheapo, Tokyo Cheapo (Diary); Eatbook, mustvisit.sg, Vanilla Luxury, middleclass.sg, DanielFoodDiary (The Table).

Long Read: Cicero, *De Divinatione* II.24 (44 BC); UK coal-mine canary retirement (Dec 1986), standard mining-safety histories; William Bruce Cameron, *Informal Sociology* (1963).